

OCTOPUSES

Did you know that octopuses are related to snails? But unlike most other mollusks, they don't have shells to protect them. Instead, these eight-armed animals squeeze their soft bodies into small cracks or holes in rocks. Once they are safely hidden, it is very hard for conger eels, sharks, seals, and people to find and eat them.



Gone fishing

Octopuses hunt for their food. They pounce on fish, starfish, and crabs. Some have webs between their arms which help them net even more animals.

With their large eyes, octopuses can see shapes and colors very well.

Tentacle

This common octopus measures only four inches (10 centimeters) from tip to tip. The largest octopus ever found was more than 30 feet (nine meters) wide!

Siphon

Bunch of eggs

Inside each of these soft-shelled eggs there is a baby octopus.



Web

An octopus can shoot ink, called sepia, out of its siphon. This black cloud hangs in the water and hides the octopus from its enemies.

Jet-propelled

If an octopus is frightened, it does not crawl away slowly—it jets off! By forcing water out through its siphon, it can shoot through the sea.